```
  def a_method_used_for_validation_purposes
    errors.add(:name, :invalid_characters, not_allowed: "!@#%*()_-+=")
  end
end

person = Person.create(name: "!@#")

person.errors.details[:name]
# => [{error: :invalid_characters, not_allowed: "!@#%*()_-+="}]
```

All built in Rails validators populate the details hash with the corresponding validator type.

7.5 errors[:base]

You can add error messages that are related to the object's state as a whole, instead of being related to a specific attribute. You can use this method when you want to say that the object is invalid, no matter the values of its attributes. Since `errors[:base]` is an array, you can simply add a string to it and it will be used as an error message.

```
class Person < ActiveRecord::Base
  def a_method_used_for_validation_purposes
    errors[:base] << "This person is invalid because ..."
  end
end
```

7.6 errors.clear

The `clear` method is used when you intentionally want to clear all the messages in the `errors`collection. Of course, calling `errors.clear` upon an invalid object won't actually make it valid: the `errors` collection will now be empty, but the next time you call `valid?` or any method that tries to save this object to the database, the validations will run again. If any of the validations fail, the `errors`collection will be filled again.

```
class Person < ActiveRecord::Base
  validates :name, presence: true, length: { minimum: 3 }
end

person = Person.new
person.valid? # => false
person.errors[:name]
 # => ["can't be blank", "is too short (minimum is 3 characters)"]

person.errors.clear
person.errors.empty? # => true

p.save # => false

p.errors[:name]
# => ["can't be blank", "is too short (minimum is 3 characters)"]
```

7.7 errors.size

The `size` method returns the total number of error messages for the object.

```
class Person < ActiveRecord::Base
  validates :name, presence: true, length: { minimum: 3 }
end

person = Person.new
person.valid? # => false
person.errors.size # => 2

person = Person.new(name: "Andrea", email: "andrea@example.com")
person.valid? # => true
```